



No Contact on the Hard Days

Getting through holidays, birthdays and anniversaries

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Special dates are where a lot of no-contact streaks end. "It's their birthday, it would be rude not to." "It's Christmas, everyone's reaching out." "It would have been our anniversary." The pull is real, and it's predictable, which means you can plan for it.

Should you text your ex on their birthday?

If you're in no contact, generally no. A birthday message almost always opens a conversation, or leaves you waiting for a reply. Ask yourself what you're hoping will happen. If the honest answer is "that they'll reply warmly and we'll talk," that's the relationship you're trying to recover from, not a courtesy.

Plan the day in advance

- Put the date in your calendar a week ahead, with a plan attached
- Book time with people you like on the day itself
- Hand your phone to a friend for the evening, or leave it at home
- Plan something you'll enjoy the next morning too

Holidays

Holidays bring family questions, couple-heavy events and lots of free time. Prepare a one-line answer ("We broke up and I'm doing okay, thanks") and change the subject. Give yourself permission to leave events early, and plan some solo time that feels good, not lonely.

Your anniversary

An anniversary can bring back the whole relationship at once. Instead of pretending it's an ordinary day, acknowledge it: write about what the relationship gave you and what you're letting go of. Then do something that's entirely about your life now.

Write the message instead of sending it

If you feel you must say something, write the full birthday or holiday message on paper. Say everything. Then keep it. You get to express the feeling without reopening the door.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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